SHIPYOURPROJECT × LYNC

Industry Research & Competitive Analysis

Women's community & events platforms — market landscape, competitor deep-dives, UX patterns, quiz funnel strategy, and design direction for the LYNC rebuild.

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Date: March 29, 2026

Client: Rebecca Nolan — LYNC Events

Version: 1.0

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1. Current State Audit — lyncevents.com

Overview

LYNC is a women's friendship community in Madrid founded by Rebecca Nolan (21, LA) and Cordelia (21, London), both IE University students. Two business lines: community/events and study abroad services.

Current Tech Stack

COMPONENT	TOOL	ISSUE
Website	WordPress + Elementor (GoDaddy hosting)	Generic template feel, slow, not custom
Scheduling	Acuity Scheduling	Siloed event data, no sync to CRM
Shop/Guides	Shopify (lync-events.myshopify.com)	Separate customer DB, separate domain
CRM	Pipedrive	Only captures form signups, not event/purchase data
Integrations	Bit Integrations plugin	WP form → Pipedrive only
Community	WhatsApp group	No data capture from community interactions
Email/CRM	HubSpot (possibly active)	Potential duplicate with Pipedrive

Site Structure

- **Home** — hero with "Join the Community" CTA (name + email only)
- **Events** — links to Acuity for booking
- **Blog** — exists but minimal content ("Tips, stories, and inspiration")
- **About** — founders story (strong, personal, authentic)
- **Study Abroad > Services** — mentorship, uni apps, visa docs, accommodation
- **Resources / Free Consultation** — study abroad services
- **Guides** — redirects to Shopify store
- **Collegiate** — accommodation partner page

Content Audit

- FAQ section on homepage is strong — addresses real concerns (age, coming alone, what to expect)
- About page copy is authentic and emotionally compelling
- Blog is essentially empty — huge SEO opportunity missed
- Events page barely has content when fetched — likely relies on Acuity embed
- No social proof (testimonials, member count, event photos) on key pages
- No personalization — every visitor gets the same generic experience

> **Core Problem:** Three disconnected databases (Pipedrive for signups, Acuity for events, Shopify for purchases) make it impossible to understand who a user is across touchpoints. A girl who attended 5 events and bought a guide looks the same as a first-time visitor in Pipedrive.

2. Market Landscape

The Women's Community & Friendship Space

The market for women's social connection platforms is booming. Loneliness epidemic data (especially post-COVID) has driven massive growth in friendship-first platforms. Key segments:

A. FRIENDSHIP APPS (DIGITAL-FIRST)

- **Bumble BFF** — swipe-based friendship matching, 2025 relaunch focused on groups
- **Gofrendly** — women-only friendship app with in-app events and interest matching
- **Peanut** — friendship for moms, pregnancy, menopause stages
- **Hey Vina** — "Tinder for female friends" (shutting down, users migrating)
- **Clockout, Clyx, Les Amis, 222** — newer entrants targeting friendship market

B. EXPERIENCE/EVENT PLATFORMS

- **Timeleft** — 3M+ members, 52 countries, matches strangers for dinners/drinks/runs. No bios, no swiping. Personality-based matching.
- **Meetup** — group activities by interest, mixed gender, massive scale
- **Eventbrite** — event discovery and ticketing (not community-focused)

C. WOMEN'S PROFESSIONAL/MEMBERSHIP NETWORKS

- **Chief** — premium membership for senior women leaders ($5,800+/yr), Clubhouses, coaching, Wharton training. 44% C-Suite, 67% of Fortune 100 represented.
- **Girlboss** — content + community for millennial career women, newsletter-first model
- **Ellevate Network** — professional women's chapters by city
- **Femme Palette** — global women's professional community with mentoring programs
- **Entreprenista League** — 2,500+ members, weekly events, expert office hours
- **BossBabe / The Société** — paid membership for female entrepreneurs

D. LOCAL MADRID COMPETITORS

- **Las Expateñas** (Meetup) — expat women in Madrid, 30s, monthly gatherings
- **American Women's Club of Madrid** — established, charitable focus, older demographic
- **Madrid Expat Women (Lean In Circle)** — professional English-speaking women

> **LYNC's Unique Position:** LYNC sits between friendship apps and professional networks. It's not a dating-adjacent swipe app (like Bumble BFF), not a tech platform (like Timeleft), and not a career network (like Chief). It's a curated, IRL-first friendship community for young international women in Madrid — with a study abroad services arm that no competitor has. This is a unique wedge.

Market Trends

1. **IRL-first, digital-second:** The best platforms use digital to facilitate in-person meetups, not replace them. LYNC already does this.
2. **Personality/quiz-based matching:** Timeleft, Bumble BFF all moving toward personality-driven group formation vs. simple interest tags.
3. **Community-as-product:** Membership models with onboarding kits, welcome flows, curated intros. LYNC already has a "Welcome & Onboarding Kit."
4. **AI integration:** Personalized recommendations, automated content, WhatsApp agents. This is where LYNC is heading.
5. **City expansion playbooks:** Timeleft went from 1 city to 200+ cities in 52 countries. LYNC wants to "spread across Europe." The platform needs to be built for this.

3. Competitor Deep-Dives

Timeleft

timeleft.com — 3M+ members, 200+ cities, 52 countries

Experience Platform | AI Matching | Global Scale

Model: Book a dinner/drinks/run → personality-matched group of strangers → venue revealed last minute → show up.

What works:

- "No bios. No swiping. No planning." — removes all friction
- Personality questionnaire drives group matching (not just interests)
- Scarcity/anticipation: venue revealed just before event
- Three formats (dinner, drinks, runs) with distinct vibes
- 720 bookings/day — proven demand for stranger-to-friend conversion

Design notes: Clean, modern, lots of whitespace. Strong social proof (3M+ members counter). Simple 3-step "how it works" flow. Mobile-first.

Weakness for LYNC to exploit: Timeleft is gender-neutral and event-generic. No community layer. No ongoing relationships — each dinner is standalone. LYNC's curated women-only community with ongoing WhatsApp + recurring events creates deeper bonds.

Gofrendly

gofrendly.com — Women-only friendship app

Women-Only | App-First | Interest Matching

Model: Download app → create profile → browse women nearby → chat → meet IRL. Also runs in-app events (sip & paint, hikes, workshops).

What works:

- Women-only creates safe, trusted environment
- Location + interest + life stage filters
- Clear 4-step onboarding (profile → browse → hello → meet)
- In-app events bridge digital to physical
- Authentic founder story (two women met over coffee → built the app)

Design notes: Warm color palette, friendly illustrations, emphasis on real photos. Strong CTA hierarchy. "Because friendship's always worth the storage space" — great micro-copy.

Weakness for LYNC to exploit: App-only (no web presence for events). Global but thin in any single city. No curated community — it's self-service matching. LYNC's hands-on events

team and Madrid focus creates deeper local density.

Chief

chief.com — Premium women's leadership membership

Premium | Membership | C-Suite

Model: Application-based membership. Physical Clubhouses + Core Groups (small coaching cohorts) + annual summits + Wharton training.

What works:

- Aspirational positioning: "Lead on. Chief exists to create more possibilities for women's power."
- Data-driven social proof: "44% of members are in the C-Suite", "67% of Fortune 100"
- Scarcity/exclusivity: application-based, vetted community
- Strong stat-based storytelling: "Women accomplish 50% more when collaborating with other women"

Design notes: Minimalist, dark backgrounds, large typography, bold stats. Premium feel without being cold. Photography is diverse and authentic.

Relevance for LYNC: Different market (senior professionals vs. young internationals), but the membership model, social proof patterns, and aspirational copy are directly transferable to LYNC's positioning.

Girlboss

girlboss.com — Content + community for millennial women

Content-First | Newsletter | 100K+ subscribers

Model: Daily newsletter + blog content hub + community. Newsletter is the growth engine. "100,000+ smart women are already subscribed."

What works:

- Newsletter-first acquisition: "Finally, an email you'll actually look forward to"
- Content categories feel curated (Wellness, How To, Success Stories, Now What?)
- Social proof embedded in CTA ("100,000+ smart women")
- Tone: confident, relatable, slightly irreverent

Design notes: Clean editorial design, card-based blog layout with strong hierarchy. Category-driven navigation. Content is the product.

Relevance for LYNC: LYNC's blog is empty — this is a missed growth channel. Blog content (Madrid tips, friendship stories, expat guides) + newsletter = organic growth engine. AI-generated blog posts are a planned feature.

Las Expateñas (Meetup Madrid)

meetup.com/expatwomenmadridconnect

Direct Local Competitor | Meetup-Based

Model: Monthly gatherings for expat women in Madrid (30s). Free to join. Focus on creating connections during life abroad.

Weaknesses vs LYNC:

- Platform-dependent (Meetup) — no brand ownership
- Targets 30s specifically — misses 18-25 student demographic
- Monthly frequency — LYNC does weekly/bi-weekly events
- No onboarding, no community chat, no membership benefits
- No brand identity beyond Meetup listing

4. Feature Comparison Matrix

FEATURE	LYNC (CURRENT)	TIMELEFT	GOFRENDLY	CHIEF	BUMBLE BFF
Women-only	□	□	□	□	□
IRL events	□	□	□	□	□
Community chat	□ (WhatsApp)	□	□ (in-app)	□	□
Personality quiz/matching	□	□	□ (interests)	□ (application)	□ (swipe)
Onboarding kit	□	□	□	□	□
Blog/content	□ (empty)	□	□ (SEO blog)	□ (articles)	□
Newsletter	□	□	□	□	□
Study abroad services	□	□	□	□	□
Guides/shop	□ (Shopify)	□	□	□	□
Personalized recs	□	□ (AI)	□ (interest)	□ (curated)	□ (algo)
Centralized user DB	□ (3 silos)	□	□	□	□
Admin dashboard	□	□	□	□	N/A
Mobile app	□	□	□	□	□
City expansion-ready	□	□ (200+ cities)	□ (multi-city)	□ (US cities)	□ (global)

Key Gap: LYNC has unique assets (women-only + IRL events + study abroad services + onboarding kit) that no single competitor matches. But the tech infrastructure is 3-5 years behind. The rebuild closes this gap while preserving what makes LYNC special.

5. Quiz Funnel Strategy & Best Practices

Why Quiz > Newsletter Signup

LYNC's current CTA is a simple name + email form labeled "Join the Community." This captures zero preference data and has a generic conversion rate. Quiz funnels consistently outperform:

- **Beardbrand:** 150,000+ leads from a single Typeform personality quiz
- **Bumpin Blends:** Quiz captures 7.5x more emails than any other form on their site
- **Ipsy:** 12-question visual quiz → lead form before results → massive conversion

Recommended Quiz Structure for LYNC

Title: **"Find Your LYNC Experience"** or **"What Kind of Friend Are You?"**

STEP 1 — WARM-UP (2 QUESTIONS)

- "What brings you to Madrid?" → Study / Work / Travel / Living here
- "How long have you been here?" → Just arrived / 1-6 months / 6-12 months / 1+ years

STEP 2 — PREFERENCES (3-4 QUESTIONS)

- "What kind of events sound most like you?" → Wellness (pilates, yoga) / Social (brunches, dinners) / Adventure (hikes, day trips) / Creative (pottery, art) / Nightlife
- "When are you usually free?" → Weekday mornings / Weekday evenings / Weekends / Flexible
- "What's your ideal group size?" → Small & intimate (4-6) / Medium (8-12) / Big energy (15+)
- "Are you interested in study abroad services?" → Yes / Not right now

STEP 3 — CAPTURE (LEAD FORM)

- Name, email, phone (optional), nationality
- Show a preview of their personalized results in the background (Topshop pattern)

STEP 4 — RESULTS

- Personalized event recommendations based on answers
- "Your next LYNC event" — show 2-3 upcoming events that match their preferences
- CTA: "Join the WhatsApp community" + "Book your first event"

> **Key Principles:**
> • Keep it under 8 questions (5-7 ideal)
> • Use images/icons for answer options (visual > text)
> • Show progress bar
> • Place lead form AFTER quiz questions, BEFORE results (curiosity drives completion)

> - Personalize the results — generic results kill the magic
> - All data flows directly into Supabase contacts table with preference tags

Quiz Funnel Tools Reference

Since we're building custom in Next.js, we don't need third-party quiz tools. But for UX reference:

- **Typeform** — best UX for conversational quizzes (Beardbrand used this)
- **ScoreApp** — quiz-specific, strong segmentation features
- **ConvertFlow** — embedded quiz funnels with personalized product recs

We'll build a custom quiz component that matches LYNC's brand and feeds directly into Supabase — no third-party dependency, full data ownership.

6. UX & Design Patterns

A. Community/Events Platform Patterns

HERO SECTION

- **Timeleft:** Bold headline + single CTA + stat counter. No clutter.
- **Chief:** Aspirational statement + "Become a member" CTA. Dark, premium.
- **Gofrendly:** Warm, personal headline + app download CTAs + "Featured in" social proof.
- **Recommendation for LYNC:** Authentic event photo/video background + emotive headline + quiz CTA button (not a form). Social proof counter ("500+ women connected").

HOW IT WORKS

- Every successful platform has a clear 3-4 step visual flow
- Timeleft: "Choose → Book → Show up" with icons
- Gofrendly: "Profile → Browse → Hello → Meet" with illustrations
- **For LYNC:** "Take the quiz → Get matched → Join an event → Make friends" (4 steps, visual icons)

EVENT CARDS

- Photo + event type tag + date + spots remaining
- Scarcity indicator ("3 spots left") drives urgency
- Category pills (Wellness, Social, Adventure) for quick scanning
- One-click registration (no redirect to Acuity)

SOCIAL PROOF PATTERNS

- Member counters (animated on scroll)
- Testimonial cards with photos + nationality flags
- Instagram feed embed showing real event moments
- "Featured in" press logos
- Community stats: "200+ friendships formed" / "50+ events hosted"

B. Design Direction Recommendations

VISUAL IDENTITY

- **Current:** LYNC uses warm yellows/golds — this is good, keep it. It's sunny, Madrid-feeling, approachable.
- **Typography:** Move from generic Elementor fonts to a modern, friendly sans-serif (Inter, Plus Jakarta Sans, or DM Sans). The current site feels template-y.

- **Photography:** LYNC's biggest asset is real event photos. Feature them prominently. Authentic > stock.
- **Illustrations:** Consider custom illustrations for the quiz flow and "how it works" section (like Gofrendly).

TONE OF VOICE

- Current copy is great — warm, personal, Gen Z-friendly. Keep it.
- "You won't stay alone for long" / "strangers turn into your new favorite people" — this is gold.
- Blog content should match this voice (not generic GPT output).
- Micro-copy matters: CTAs should feel inviting, not transactional. "Find your people" > "Sign up"

MOBILE-FIRST

- Target demo (18-30, international women) is 90%+ mobile
- Quiz must be thumb-friendly (large tap targets, swipe interactions)
- Event booking must be seamless on mobile
- Consider PWA for app-like experience without App Store overhead

C. Design References

REFERENCE	WHAT TO STUDY	URL
Timeleft	How it works flow, booking UX, social proof counters	timeleft.com
Chief	Aspirational copy, stat-driven social proof, premium feel	chief.com
Gofrendly	Warm visual tone, 4-step onboarding, women-only positioning	gofrendly.com
Girlboss	Blog layout, newsletter CTA, content categorization	girlboss.com
C2 Montreal	Event website energy, vibrant design (Awwwards SOTD)	c2mtl.com
Dribbble: Community Platform	UI patterns for event cards, member profiles, dashboards	dribbble.com/tags/community-platform
Dribbble: Event UI	Event card designs, booking flows, calendar views	dribbble.com/tags/event-ui

7. SWOT Analysis — LYNC

STRENGTHS

- Authentic founder story + personal brand
- Women-only positioning (safe, trusted)
- Real IRL events with proven attendance
- Onboarding kit differentiator
- Dual revenue stream (events + study abroad)
- Active WhatsApp community
- IE University network access
- Warm, emotionally compelling copy

⚠ WEAKNESSES

- Fragmented tech stack (3 DBs, no sync)
- WordPress template site (not custom)
- Empty blog (missed SEO opportunity)
- No personalization or segmentation
- Manual event management
- No analytics on member behavior
- Study abroad & community feel disconnected on site
- Guides on separate Shopify domain

OPPORTUNITIES

- Quiz funnel → 5-10x lead capture improvement
- AI-powered blog (SEO traffic engine)
- WhatsApp AI agent for personalized recs
- City expansion (Barcelona, Lisbon, London)
- Membership tiers (free vs premium events)
- Hey Vina shutting down → users seeking alternatives
- Partnership with university study abroad offices
- Newsletter as growth channel (Girlboss model)
- Admin dashboard → Rebecca self-serves, less manual work

THREATS

- Bumble BFF relaunch (2025) with group focus
- Timeleft expanding in Madrid market
- Low barriers to entry (anyone can make a Meetup group)
- Dependence on founder energy for event curation
- Student demographic = high churn (graduation, moving)
- WhatsApp community could become unmanageable at scale

8. Recommendations & Design Direction

A. Platform Architecture

1. **Single source of truth:** Supabase as the centralized database for all user data (signups, event registrations, guide purchases, quiz responses, preferences)
2. **Next.js website:** Replace WordPress with a fast, custom-built site that reflects LYNC's brand quality
3. **Keep Acuity + Shopify (for now):** Webhook into Supabase on every transaction. Replace later as platform matures.
4. **Admin dashboard:** Custom panel for Rebecca to manage contacts, view event data, generate blog posts, send notifications

B. Key Feature Priorities

1. **Quiz funnel CTA** — Replace generic form with personality quiz. Highest leverage change for lead quality + quantity.
2. **Event showcase** — Beautiful event cards with photos, categories, spots remaining, one-click registration. No redirect to Acuity.
3. **Social proof everywhere** — Member counter, testimonials, event photos, community stats.
4. **Blog + SEO engine** — AI-assisted content generation matching Rebecca's voice. Topics: Madrid city guides, friendship tips, expat life, event recaps.
5. **WhatsApp AI agent** — Answers questions, recommends events, provides Madrid tips, captures preferences.
6. **Study abroad services** — Better integrated into main site (not a confusing sidebar nav item). Clear funnel: landing page → free consultation booking.

C. Design Principles for Rebuild

1. **Warmth over polish.** LYNC is about belonging, not exclusivity. Design should feel inviting, not intimidating.
2. **Real photos > stock.** LYNC has real events with real women. Use them. This is the biggest differentiator vs template competitors.
3. **Mobile-first, always.** Target demo lives on their phones. Every interaction designed for thumb-first.
4. **Reduce clicks to value.** Quiz → personalized event recommendation → booking should be < 3 minutes.
5. **Build for expansion.** Multi-city support in the data model from day one. City selector, localized events, timezone-aware.

D. Content Strategy

- **Blog categories:** Madrid Guides / Friendship Tips / Event Recaps / Study Abroad / Community Stories
- **Publishing cadence:** 2-3 AI-assisted posts per week (reviewed by Rebecca for voice)
- **Newsletter:** Weekly community digest — upcoming events, new blog posts, member spotlights
- **Social proof loop:** Event photos → Instagram → website gallery → more signups

9. References & Inspiration Links

Competitor Sites

PLATFORM	URL	CATEGORY
Timeleft	timeleft.com	Experience/Events
Gofrendly	gofrendly.com	Women's Friendship App
Chief	chief.com	Women's Leadership Membership
Girlboss	girlboss.com	Content + Community
Femme Palette	femmepalette.com/membership	Women's Professional Community
Ellevate Network	ellevatenetwork.com	Professional Women's Chapters
Bumble BFF	bumble.com	Friendship Matching
Peanut	peanut-app.io	Moms Community
Las Expateñas (Madrid)	meetup.com/expatwomenmadridconnect	Local Competitor
American Women's Club Madrid	awcmadrid.org	Local Competitor

Design Inspiration

SOURCE	URL	LOOK AT
Awwwards — Events	awwwards.com/websites/events	Top event website designs
C2 Montreal (SOTD)	c2mtl.koki-kiko.com	Vibrant event website energy
Dribbble — Community Platform	dribbble.com/tags/community-platform	Community UI patterns
Dribbble — Event UI	dribbble.com/tags/event-ui	Event card & booking designs

Dribbble — Community App	dribbble.com/tags/community-app	Mobile community patterns
Sommo — Best Event Sites 2025	sommo.io/blog/best-event-websites	Curated event site breakdown

Quiz Funnel References

RESOURCE	URL	TAKEAWAY
Drip — 7 Quiz Funnel Examples	drip.com/blog/quiz-funnel-examples	Beardbrand, Topshop, Ipsy patterns
OptiMonk — 15 Quiz Funnels	optimonk.com/quiz-funnel-examples	Lead capture placement strategy
ScoreApp	scoreapp.com	Quiz funnel SaaS reference
Perspective — 11 Tools Tested	perspective.co/article/quiz-funnel-software	Tool comparison for reference

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